

The Great Migration

Connect the people, places, and changes of the Great Migration, when about six million African Americans moved from the rural South to cities across the country.

? Historical challenge

Between about 1910 and 1970, roughly six million African Americans left the rural South and moved to cities in the North, Midwest, and West — one of the largest movements of people in U.S. history. Who moved, where did they go, and what changed because of it? Map how people, place, and change connect.

1 Investigate

SOURCES 1

Jacob Lawrence: The Migration Series (The Phillips Collection)

PRIMARY SOURCE

Sixty painted panels (1940–41) telling the story of the Great Migration.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- What does one panel show about why people moved or what they found?
- How does art help us understand history?

SOURCES 2

The Great Migration – Classroom Materials (Library of Congress)

SECONDARY SOURCE

Background and primary sources on one of the largest internal migrations in U.S. history.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- What were two reasons families chose to move north?
- What is one thing that stayed hard even after moving?

SOURCES 3

The Great Migration – African American Heritage (National Archives)

SECONDARY SOURCE

Overview of the two waves of the migration and their effects.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- About how many people moved, and over how many years?
- How were the two waves connected to the world wars?

2 Build your Event Map

Fill in the organizer from the evidence. Mark information with ①②③ to show which source it came from. Leave a space blank if the sources don't tell you.

THE EVENT		
The Great Migration		
about 1910–1970		
The rural South to Northern, Midwestern, and Western cities		
Who? 	Where? 	What changed?
How were people, place, and change connected? 		
Sources 1	Sources 2	Sources 3

3 Compare

- Compare your three lenses with a partner. Did you connect the same people to the same places and changes?
- Which change do you think mattered most to families who moved? Why?

4 Expand

Your teacher will add context, vocabulary, and information the sources leave out. Add it to your map.

5 Revise

Go back to your Event Map. Add, correct, or reorganize based on the discussion.

6 Conclude

In your own words, explain how people, place, and change connect in the Great Migration. Use at least one detail from each lens and one source.